

Ἀριστοτέλης

Aristotle on Ethics, Nature, and the Soul

eul_aid: hgw

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Ἀττική](#) [Attic](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Πραγματεία](#) [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Aristotelian](#)

Aristotle was a Greek philosopher who lived from 384 to 322 BCE. He was born in Stagira in northern Greece. His father served as a physician to the Macedonian royal court, which likely influenced Aristotle's later interest in biology.

As a young man, he moved to Athens to study at Plato's Academy, where he remained for about twenty years. After Plato's death, he left Athens, spent time in Asia Minor conducting biological research, and then served as tutor to the young Alexander the Great of Macedon. He returned to Athens in 335 BCE to found his own school, the Lyceum. He left Athens again in 323 BCE following Alexander's death and died in exile the next year.

His extensive surviving works are treatises that cover logic, physics, biology, metaphysics, ethics, politics, and literary theory. Major titles include the *Physics*, *Metaphysics*, *Nicomachean Ethics*, *Politics*, and *Poetics*. According to modern scholars, these texts represent only a portion of his output; his more popular writings are lost. The exact number and organization of his treatises remain subjects of academic discussion.

Aristotle's historical importance is foundational. He created the first comprehensive philosophical system in the West, inventing and defining entire fields of study. His work in logic, especially his theory of the syllogism, dominated the subject for centuries. His scientific theories shaped medieval thought, and his detailed biological observations were unmatched in the ancient world. His ethical and political ideas, centered on virtue and human flourishing, continue to be central to philosophy. Through later Arabic and Latin translations, he became the central authority for medieval scholars and remains a major figure in contemporary philosophical debate.

Works (56)

- [Διαιρέσεις Ἀριστοτελικαί](#) · [Aristotelian Divisions](#) · 99 passages
- [Ἐπιστολαὶ πρὸς Φίλιππον](#) · [Aristotle's Letters to Philip](#) · 7 passages
- [Ἀριστοτέλους φυσικὰ προβλήματα κατ' εἶδος](#) · [Aristotle's Natural Problems by Type](#) · 218 passages
- [Κατηγορίαι](#) · [Categories](#) · 30 passages
- [Διάφορα Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Dialogic Fragments](#) · 796 passages
- [Οἰκονομικά](#) · [Economics](#) · 22 passages
- [Ἠθικά Εὐδήμεια](#) · [Eudemian Ethics](#) · 72 passages
- [Προτρεπτικός](#) · [Exhortation](#) · 78 passages
- [Ἀθηναίων πολιτεία](#) · [Fragments of Lost First Part](#) · 265 passages

- Ἐκ τοῦ περὶ ἀκουστών · From-Things Heard · 10 passages
- Μεγάλα Ἠθικά · Great Ethics · 388 passages
- Περὶ Τὰ Ζῶα Ἱστορίαι · History of Animals · 307 passages
- Ἀπόσπασμα · Hymn to Virtue · 1 passages
- Μηχανικά · Mechanics · 24 passages
- τὰ Μετὰ τὰ Φυσικά · Metaphysics · 228 passages
- Μετεωρολογικά · Meteorology · 105 passages
- Ἠθικά Νικομάχεια · Nicomachean Ethics · 176 passages
- Περί χρωμάτων · On Colors · 18 passages
- Περὶ Μαντικῆς κατὰ Ὑπνον · On Divination by Sleep · 5 passages
- Περὶ Ἐνυπνίων · On Dreams · 10 passages
- Περὶ Γενέσεως καὶ Φθορᾶς · On Generation and Corruption · 50 passages
- Περὶ ἀτόμων γραμμῶν · On Indivisible Lines · 10 passages
- Περὶ Ἑρμηνείας · On Interpretation · 18 passages
- Περὶ θαυμασίων ἀκουσμάτων · On Marvelous Tales · 36 passages
- Περὶ Μνήμης καὶ Ἀναμνήσεως · On Memory and Recollection · 9 passages
- Περὶ Ζώων Μορίων · On Parts of Animals · 118 passages
- Περὶ φυτῶν · On Plants · 484 passages
- Περὶ ποιητικῆς · On Poetics · 32 passages
- Περὶ Ἀναπνοῆς · On Respiration · 21 passages
- Περὶ Αἰσθήσεως καὶ Αἰσθητῶν · On Sense and Sensibles · 27 passages
- Περὶ Ὑπνου καὶ Ἑγρηγόρσεως · On Sleep and Wakefulness · 10 passages
- Περὶ Σοφιστικῶν Ἐλέγχων · On Sophistical Refutations · 42 passages
- Περὶ Ζώων Πορείας · On the Gait of Animals · 22 passages
- Περὶ Ζώων Γενέσεως · On the Generation of Animals · 150 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα · On the Good and Happy Life · 2 passages
- Περὶ Οὐρανοῦ · On the Heavens · 92 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα · On the Inundation of the Nile · 4 passages
- Περὶ Μακροβιότητος καὶ Βραχυβιότητος · On the Length and Shortness of Life · 7 passages
- Περὶ Ζώων Κινήσεως · On the Movement of Animals · 13 passages
- Περὶ Ψυχῆς · On the Soul · 68 passages
- Περὶ Ψυχῆς · On the Soul (Excerpts) · 12 passages
- Περὶ Ψυχῆς · On the Soul (Fragmentary) · 10 passages
- Περὶ Πνεύματος · On the Spirit · 12 passages
- Περὶ Κόσμου · On the World · 22 passages
- περὶ Ἀρετῶν καὶ Κακιῶν · On Virtues and Vices · 6 passages
- Περὶ Ξενοφάνους, περὶ Ζήνωνος, περὶ Γοργίου · On Xenophanes, Zeno, Gorgias · 15 passages
- Περὶ Νεότητος καὶ Γήρωος · On Youth and Old Age, Life and Death · 7 passages
- Φυσικὴ Ἀκρόασις · Physics · 173 passages
- Φυσικὴ Ἀκρόασις · Physics, Alternate Text · 16 passages
- Φυσιογνωμονικά · Physiognomics · 20 passages
- Πολιτικά · Politics · 181 passages
- Ἀνέμων θέσεις καὶ προσηγορίαι · Positions and Names of Winds · 2 passages

- [Ἀναλυτικὰ Πρότερα · Prior Analytics](#) · 155 passages
- [Ῥητορική · Rhetoric](#) · 133 passages
- [Μαρτυρίαι · Testimonies](#) · 6 passages
- [Τοπικά · Topics](#) · 130 passages

Other Aristotelian Authors

- [Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἀφροδισιεύς · Alexander of Aphrodisias](#) · 16 works
- [Ἀνώνυμος εἰς τὰς Κατηγορίας τοῦ Ἀριστοτέλους · Anonymous Commentary on Aristotle](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀνώνυμος ἐν Ἠθικοῖς Νικομαχείοις · Anonymous Commentary on Aristotle](#) · 3 works
- [Ἀπολλώνιος ὁ Ἀφροδισιεύς · Apollonius of Aphrodisias](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀνώνυμος Ἀριστοτέλους Σοφιστικῶν Ἑλέγχων · Sophistical Refutations Anonymous](#) · 6 works